FaujPrep

Initial Test 1: Build the Skills Before Chasing a Score

What this note is for

Candidates commonly practise reasoning and school-level academic skills for screening, but a Long Course 160-specific section list was not publicly verifiable during research for this note. Exact format, timing, subjects, and qualifying rules may change. Treat your call-up instructions and current official guidance as final. This plan develops useful skills without pretending that one paper or a coaching pattern predicts the live test.

Start with a baseline

Take one short, timed diagnostic in each area you expect to practise: verbal reasoning, non-verbal reasoning, and academic subjects relevant to your eligibility and current instructions. Do not study the questions first. Record accuracy, time spent, and the reason for every error:

- Knowledge gap: you did not know the fact or rule.
- Reasoning gap: you knew the material but chose the wrong method.
- Reading gap: you missed a condition, unit, or negative word.
- Pacing gap: you spent too long on one item.
- Careless slip: arithmetic, marking, or transcription error.

This error log is more useful than repeatedly taking full tests without reviewing them.

Practise the three skill groups

Verbal reasoning: Review number and letter sequences, analogies, classification, coding rules, directions, relations, ranks, and basic statement-conclusion logic. For each item, state the rule in one sentence before selecting an option. On word questions, read every option; do not choose a familiar-looking synonym without checking the meaning in context.

Non-verbal reasoning: Practise rotations, reflections, shape counts, position changes, shading, and simple matrices. Track one feature at a time: orientation, number, location, and fill. A mirror image is not the same as a rotation. If a sequence seems unclear, compare two consecutive figures and write exactly what changed.

Academic recall: Build concise revision sheets from your school-level syllabus and confirmed test guidance. Focus first on concepts and common formulas, then practise mixed questions. For science and mathematics, show a short working; for general facts, record the source and date so that you can update them.

Worked question-solving tricks

Number series: use differences before guessing a formula
Example: 3, 8, 15, 24, ?

Write the gaps: 5, 7, 9. They increase by 2, so the next gap is 11 and the answer is 35. Check against

the choices. If the gaps do not reveal a rule, check ratios, alternating positions, squares/cubes, or two interleaved sequences—in that order. Do not invent a complicated rule if a simpler one fits every term.

Letter series: convert letters to positions
Example: B, E, I, N, ?

Positions are 2, 5, 9, 14. The jumps are +3, +4, +5, so the next jump is +6: 14 + 6 = 20, which is T. The position method also makes wrap-around visible: after Z, restart at A only if the pattern supports it.

Directions: draw a tiny compass
Example: Walk 4 km east, then 3 km north. The displacement is the diagonal of a right triangle, not 7 km: " ($4^2 + 3^2$) = 5 km. If the question asks distance travelled, add the path (7 km); if it asks shortest distance from the start, use the diagonal. That wording changes the answer.

Analogy: name the relationship, not just the topic
Example: Thermometer : temperature :: barometer : ? First state the link: "instrument measures." A barometer measures air pressure. For person-place, tool-use, part-whole, and cause-effect analogies, say the relation aloud and test it in the same direction on both pairs.

Non-verbal matrices: make a feature table
For each cell, track four features separately: shape, count, position, shading. Example: if row 1 is one black circle, one white circle, then one black plus one white circle, the third cell may be the combination of the first two. Verify the same operation on another row before choosing. For an arrow sequence, compare orientation first, then count and dot location; do not jump to "rotation" if the number of shapes also changes.

Statement-conclusion questions: test possibility, not plausibility
Premises: "All cadets are students. Some students are athletes." Conclusion: "Some cadets are athletes." This does not necessarily follow: the athletes could be students outside the cadet group. A conclusion follows only when the premises force it to be true. Sketch circles if needed; never add a real-world assumption.

Fast error check

Before submitting, ask: What exactly is asked—path or displacement, next term or missing term, all or some, not or except? Then substitute your chosen option back into the rule. This catches many avoidable errors without re-solving the whole question.

A repeatable 30-minute session

1. Spend 5 minutes revising yesterday's errors.
2. Do 10 minutes of one focused skill without a timer.
3. Do 10 minutes of mixed timed questions.
4. Spend 5 minutes correcting and logging errors.

Increase difficulty gradually. Keep a separate set of unseen questions for timed practice; memorising answer patterns can create false confidence.

Checkpoint

Once a week, take a mixed practice set under quiet conditions. Compare accuracy and decision time with your baseline. If accuracy falls when timed, slow down enough to read carefully, then shorten the

time limit in small steps. The aim is dependable reasoning, not panic-speed guessing.

Reminder

Practice improves preparation but cannot guarantee a pass or selection. Eligibility, the live test, medical assessment, vacancies, and official decisions are outside a candidate's control.

Research basis

The Join Pakistan Army portal (https://joinpakarmy.gov.pk/) is the official recruitment source. Its accessible public information did not verify a PMA Long Course 160 question breakdown or threshold during research for this note. Confirm your own current instructions before relying on any test pattern.